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Individual Submission by:

Amit Sahai

For background purposes only, please see brief biographical sketch below.

This brief note is to encourage the Action Plan to create a large-scale centralized GPU computing facility for AI research, where US researchers from all research fields can participate. Priorities or usage budgets should be determined solely on merit, but not requiring the time-consuming process of proposal writing and evaluation. Instead, each applicant can submit up to 3 lifetime awards that they have won, and there can be a pre-published "score chart" that assigns scores to a variety of major research awards across different fields. The scores corresponding to the 3 awards would be added, and this would determine priority or usage budgets for the applicant for the next period (e.g. 1 year). Awards should be easily verifiable and significant, for example being named a Fellow of a major research society (across disciplines), or major awards given by research societies and the National Academies. Allowing applicants to only submit 3 awards disincentivizes award-spamming. This process would obviate the need for expensive and delay-inducing proposal writing and review, and instead reward proven track records of innovation. This would also encourage highly creative scientists who have not previously thought about working on AI to work on AI research.

Bio Sketch:

Amit Sahai is a Professor of Computer Science and (by courtesy) Mathematics at UCLA, and the incumbent of the Symantec Endowed Chair in Computer Science. He also serves as an Advisor to the Prison Mathematics Project. His primary research interests are in cryptography, coding theory, complexity theory, and security. He is the co-inventor of attribute-based encryption, functional encryption, and indistinguishability obfuscation. He was an invited lecturer at the 2022 International Congress of Mathematicians (ICM 2022, Special Sectional Lecture), and received the 2022 National Academy of Sciences Held Prize for his role in the development of indistinguishability obfuscation. His research works have been recognized by five Test of Time Awards (STOC 2024, FOCS 2023, Eurocrypt 2023, Eurocrypt 2020, ACM CCS 2016), a STOC 2021 Best Paper Award, and a 2024 EMNLP Outstanding Paper Award. For his teaching, he was given the 2016 Lockheed Martin Excellence in Teaching Award from the Samueli School of Engineering at UCLA. Many years ago, he was a member of the 1996 World Champion ACM ICPC Team from UC Berkeley. He is also a Simons Investigator (2021), Fellow of the ACM (2018), Fellow of the IACR (2019), and Fellow of the AMS (2024).

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